

Empathy Map — Trekkers / Hikers in Remote and Network-Deprived Areas

SAYS ● “What if I lose mobile signal in there?” ● “How do I even contact anyone from this spot?” ● “I need my exact location to reach the rescue team, not just ‘somewhere near the ridge.’” ● “I don't want to carry another complicated gadget on top of everything else.” ● “Is there anyone else out here who could pass this along for me?”	THINKS ● What if I become completely unreachable out here? ● Will anyone actually respond in time if I do send an SOS? ● Do I have enough battery left for an emergency later? ● Is my GPS position accurate right now, or still acquiring? ● Did my SOS actually reach someone, or did it just vanish? ● Is there even another TerraLink user anywhere near me to forward this?
DOES ● Carries a phone and basic emergency/trekking equipment. ● Checks cellular network availability out of habit, expecting none. ● Uses GPS/offline maps for daytime navigation. ● Moves toward higher or more open ground when physically able. ● Presses SOS only when the situation genuinely requires it. ● Waits for an acknowledgement or sign that rescue is coming. ● Consciously conserves battery once in a low-coverage stretch.	FEELS ● Mild unease entering a known dead-zone stretch. ● Isolation once every signal indicator disappears. ● Fear and urgency at the actual moment of injury or distress. ● Uncertainty in the silence right after pressing SOS. ● Relief once an SOS acknowledgement is actually confirmed. ● Renewed confidence once location has been successfully transmitted.

PAINS ● No cellular network across most of the trekking route. ● Difficult terrain — valleys, dense canopy, ridgelines that block signal further. ● Uncertainty about whether a reported location is actually accurate. ● GPS fix can take noticeable time to acquire, right when time matters most. ● Battery is limited and already shared across phone, camera, and torch. ● No nearby communication device in genuinely isolated stretches. ● No way to know whether an SOS actually reached anyone. ● Total dependence on however long rescue response takes once alerted.	GAINS / NEEDS ● A simple, fast way to activate an SOS under stress. ● GPS location transmitted automatically as part of the alert. ● Long-range LoRa communication that doesn't depend on cellular towers. ● A clear acknowledgement that the SOS actually left the device. ● Low-power operation that doesn't compete with other essential gear. ● A portable design that adds minimal weight or bulk. ● Minimal technical interaction — no networking knowledge required. ● Passive benefit from any nearby TerraLink user's device forwarding for them. ● Confidence that rescue teams have a real chance of locating them.
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KEY USER INSIGHT

1. The user does not primarily need another communication gadget; they need confidence that an SOS carrying their location can reach someone when cellular infrastructure simply isn't there.
2. Silence after pressing SOS is as distressing as the emergency itself — a clear acknowledgement matters as much as the transmission.
3. Reliability depends on whether another TerraLink user happens to be nearby — this is a real, honest constraint the design must communicate rather than obscure.

USER PERSONA

